

**David Romer's Rules for Making It Through Graduate School and Finishing
Your Dissertation**

"Out in Five"

- **Don't clutter up your life with other activities; just write.**
- **Don't carry out a thorough and comprehensive search of the literature; just write.**
- **Don't attempt to make sure that every page you write shows the full extent of your professional skills; just write.**
- **Don't write a well-organized, well-integrated, unified dissertation; just write.**
 - **Don't think profound thoughts that shake the intellectual foundations of the discipline; just write.**
- **If you don't have a paper started by the spring of your third year, be alarmed.**
- **If you don't have a paper largely drafted by the fall of your fourth year, panic.**
 - **Have three new ideas a week while you are getting started.**
- **Don't try to game the profession, work on what interests you.**
- **Good papers in economics have three characteristics:**
 - **A viewpoint.**
 - **A lever.**
 - **A result.**